

SEASON SPECIAL · YAJANG

Autumn starts outside

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3.9×

Last year's Sep peak
vs the summer low

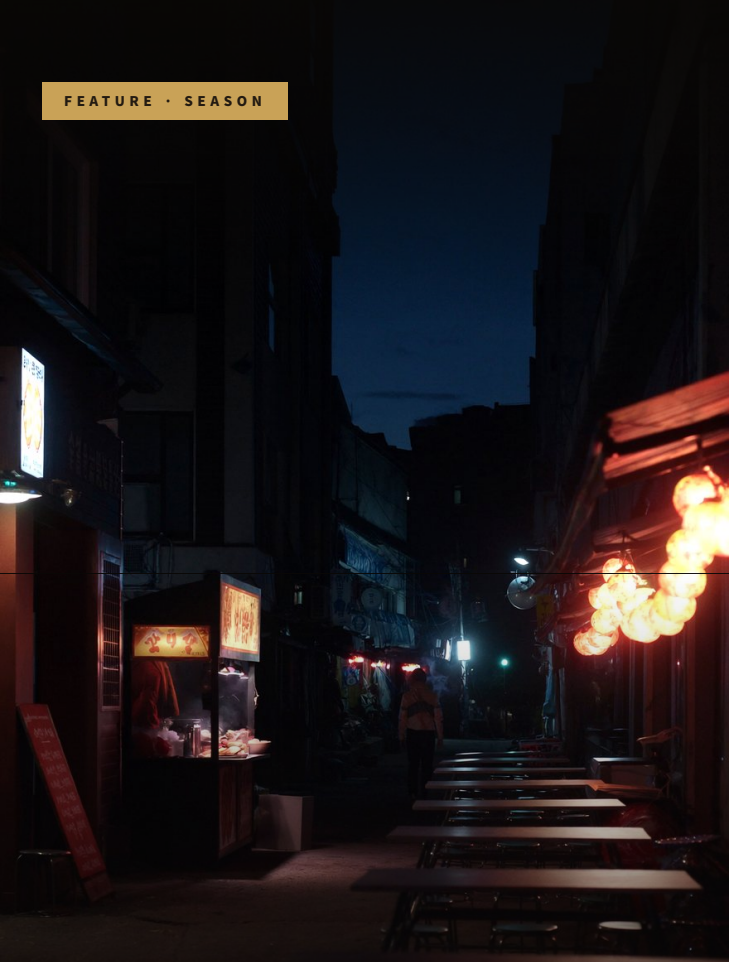
1.75×

August yajang share
vs the same week in 2025

+31%

Izakaya openings vs
market average (Jan–Aug)

Editor's note — Last month we saw the summer outdoor indicators turn down and read it as “the yajang season is ending.” The opposite is true. **August was not the end. It was the bottom.** This issue starts there.



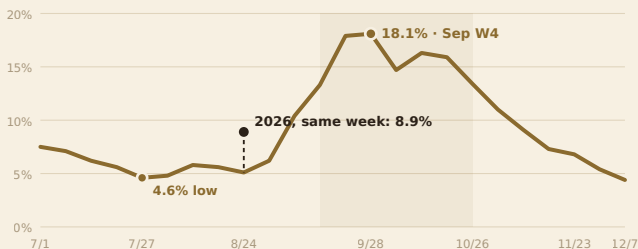
August was the bottom

Yajang is not a summer business. In August it is too hot to sit outside at all. Open up last year's data and the hottest week for yajang was the **last week of September**.

It was autumn, not summer

Sewang Trading tracked weekly Instagram mentions of ‘yajang’ — the outdoor street-side seating a bar puts out front. Volume shifts year to year, so we divided by ‘beer’ mentions and read it as a share.

2025 WEEKLY ‘YAJANG’ MENTION SHARE · VS BEER (%)
GOLDEN ZONE



Here is how last year moved. It bottomed at **4.6%** in late July, sat in the 5% range through August, started up at 10.4% in the first week of September, then jumped to 17.9% in week three and **18.1%** in week four — **3.9 times** the low. It held 13–16% through October, then fell back to the summer floor of 5.4% by late November.

2024 had the same shape: a floor in August, and October mentions running 1.8 times the August level. A pattern that repeats two years running is not a fad. It is a **season**.

IN ONE LINE

The real yajang season runs from the second week of September to the last week of October — about seven weeks.

Source: Sometrend Instagram trend (2024·2025 monthly / 2025.7–12 and 2026.6–8 weekly). The most recent one to two weeks are excluded as incomplete.

The temperature that opens yajang

Lay the curve over Seoul temperatures and the answer appears. Yajang share peaks at a **daily mean of 15–23°C**. On Seoul normals, September (21.6°C) and October (15.0°C) sit inside that band; November (7.5°C) falls out. August falls out the other side — too hot.

Seoul daily mean	Yajang share	Status
26°C+ · August	around 5%	Too hot to sit
15–23°C · Sep–Oct	13–18%	Golden Zone
About 12°C · early Nov	11%	Decline begins
About 8°C · mid-Nov	7%	Effectively over

Too hot fails, too cold fails. **The line is a daily mean of 12°C**. Below that, outdoor seats empty out fast.

THIS YEAR

Yajang share in the fourth week of August this year was **8.9%** — **1.75 times** the same week last year (5.1%). It also reached 16.8% back in June: a valley at midsummer with a hill on either side, and both hills are higher than last year’s. **This autumn’s yajang will be bigger.**

In ordering terms: the lines that turn on outdoor seats — draft beer kegs, bottled beer, soju — **go up starting with this week’s order**. The turn back is the first week of November. Do not build indoor stock now; just fix the items and quantities in advance.

Source: Korea Meteorological Administration Seoul climate normals (1991–2020) / Sometrend Instagram weekly trend. Temperature bands map the 2025 curve onto Seoul monthly means.

Three holidays in the Golden Zone

Eighteen days, 24 Sep to 11 Oct. Ten are holidays, eight are trading days — and all of them sit inside the yajang Golden Zone.

Segment	Dates	Notes
Chuseok break	9/24 Thu–9/27 Sun	4 days · no substitute
Trading window ①	9/28 Mon–10/2 Fri	5 days · dinner rebound
Foundation Day	10/3 Sat–10/5 Mon	3 days · 10/5 substitute
Trading window ②	10/6 Tue–10/8 Thu	3 days · one order only
Hangul Day	10/9 Fri–10/11 Sun	3 days

BACKWARD ORDER CALENDAR

9/9 Wed	Season opens — review higher volumes on draft, bottled beer and soju
9/16 Wed	First order — pre-Chuseok weekend (9/19–20) plus holiday run-up
9/18–9/21	Recommended cutoff for final holiday orders
9/23 Wed	Last delivery before the break
9/24–9/27	Distribution closed · on-call cover
9/28 Mon	Deliveries resume — peak plus dinner week

The part to watch is not the holidays but **the eight days between them**. 9/28–10/2 and 10/6–10/8 — short, but dinners pile up and it is the middle of the Golden Zone. Order for the holidays alone and you are out of stock on the days that sell.

Delivery and cutoff dates around the October holidays will be confirmed individually by your sales manager.



The bars opening now are izakayas

Count only the bars that close and you see half the picture. **The ones that open** tell you the next market.

The face of new openings is changing

The number of bars is falling. On National Tax Service data, casual drinking houses went from 16,226 in March 2018 to 7,985 this March, and beer halls from 36,076 to 20,193, down 44%. The two lost nearly 3,000 outlets in the past year.

Yet the mix of what opens is shifting. We counted 'new opening' posts on Naver Blog by category, January–August against the same months last year. Below is the **relative change**, net of the 29.5% overall rise.

Category	vs market avg	Absolute
Izakaya	+31.0%	+69.6%
Beer hall · draft	−2.8%	+25.8%
Pojangmacha	−4.7%	+23.3%
Wine bar	−16.2%	+8.5%
Highball	−38.1%	−19.9%

The two ends stand out. Izakayas ran far above the market average, and August alone was the strongest month in twenty. Highball is the **only one of the five to fall in absolute terms**.

That does not mean highball is dead. But blog posts mentioning it fell 24.5% year on year: highball has slipped from 'an item you open a bar around' to '**a drink every bar has**'. Izakaya mentions held flat.

FOLLOWING LAST ISSUE

Japanese beer imports rose **33.5% in the first half, a ten-year high** (Korea Customs Service). The new izakayas sell it. Draft plus sake plus skewers and fried snacks **suits yajang seating**.

Three yajang questions: is your bar ready?

Q1 OUTDOOR SEATS

Have you secured the seats you will put outside? The Golden Zone runs seven weeks, from mid-September to the end of October. Last year its peak was 3.9 times the summer floor.

Q2 KEG TURNOVER

Have you raised keg turnover and chilling capacity from this week? More outdoor seats means more first rounds. The cutoff for final holiday orders is **9/18–21**, and the last delivery is **Wed 9/23**.

Q3 NOVEMBER PLAN

Do you have an indoor line-up for November? Last year yajang collapsed from the first week of November and was back at the summer floor by the last. The line is 12°C. No need to build stock now — just fix items and volumes for sake and warm snacks.

If two or more of the three are still untouched, you will let the most reliable demand of the autumn go by.

Item	Now–Oct	From Nov
Draft beer kegs	Increase	Reduce
Bottled beer · soju	Increase	Hold
Sake	Hold	Increase
Whisky on the rocks	Hold	Increase
Highball mixers	Hold	Hold

Your sales manager will propose a keg, bottled beer and soju mix sized to your outdoor seating and your venue.

The late heat has broken

Last issue we said to keep three signals lit — whisky on the rocks, preference for outdoor seats, and warm bar snacks. The Korea Meteorological Administration mid-range forecast issued on 8 September puts mornings at 14–22°C and afternoons at 24–30°C through mid-month, close to normal.

In other words, the heat that ran all through August has broken. Seoul’s September normal daily mean is **21.6°C — the top of the yajang Golden Zone (15–23°C)**. The second signal, outdoor seating, had not turned down. It had only just opened.

Whisky on the rocks is still quiet, and warm snacks are early — sake mentions have moved sideways all summer. No reason to rush. **The reference point for both is the first week of November.**

Forecast issued 9/8	Normal	Verdict
Morning 14–22°C	15–21°C	Near normal
Daytime 24–30°C	25–28°C	Near normal
Seoul Sep mean 21.6°C	Zone 15–23°C	Top of the zone

CHECK THIS WEEK

① Is outdoor turnover up on last week? ② Is draft a bigger share of first rounds? ③ Closing later? Three yeses: you are in the zone.

Source: KMA mid-range forecast (issued 2026.9.8 06:00, nationwide) and Seoul climate normals (1991–2020)

NEXT ISSUE

The districts are rotating — Seongsu and Yongridan-gil are past their peak while Sindang rises. Next issue: the data on Seoul’s drinking-district rotation, plus a final pre-Chuseok order reminder.

A partner that grows alongside you

From yajang season volumes to the dinner weeks between holidays and urgent stock during the break, your sales manager will advise you. Founded in 1978, Sewang Trading has served Seoul and Gyeonggi for nearly 50 years.

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Park Jung-eon Exec. Dir.	010-3286-9489
Gangnam Daechi · Samseong / Seocho · Bangbae / Gwanak · Dongjak	
Son Seung-il Man. Dir.	010-7539-3535
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Gangbuk · Jongno · Jung-gu / Dongdaemun · Jungnang · Nowon · Dobong	
Chae Hyun-yong Director	010-8889-3057
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New account development	

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